

Library	Type	License	Pricing (USD)	Stack Fit	HTML/CSS Support	Active Maintenance	Merits	Demerits	Best Use Case	Recommendation
QuestPDF	Backend .NET library	MIT (Community) / Commercial above \$1M revenue	Free for orgs under \$1M revenue; Professional ~\$	ASP.NET Core (.NET 6/7/8/9) - native fit	No (code-based fluent C# layout API)	Very active (v2025.x; weekly commits)	Modern fluent C# API; predictable Flexbox-style la	No HTML/CSS rendering (must build layout in code); paid license once revenue exceeds \$1M; small learning curve for designers	Structured EHS reports - incident forms; audit cer	STRONGLY RECOMMENDED for backend - best free .NET option for structured documents
PuppeteerSharp	Backend .NET library (headless Chromium)	MIT	Free	ASP.NET Core - native fit	Yes - full modern HTML5/CSS3/JS via Chromium	Active (Hardcoded fork well maintained)	Pixel-perfect rendering; handles modern CSS Grid	Chromium runtime ~170MB on server; slower per-doc (300ms-2s); higher memory; needs sandboxing tweaks on Windows IIS; concurrency requires browser pool	Render existing React dashboards or HTML repor	RECOMMENDED if you need to print existing UI screens (dashboards/forms) to PDF
Gotenberg	Backend service (Docker microservice)	MIT	Free (self-hosted)	Stack-agnostic - call REST API from .NET	Yes - Chromium engine; also LibreOffice/Markdown	Very active (v8.x)	Microservice isolation (no Chromium on IIS box);	Extra Docker service to deploy and monitor; network hop; not in-process	Centralized PDF generation across multiple apps;	RECOMMENDED if EHS plans more PDF workloads - clean separation of concerns
PdfSharp / MigraDoc	Backend .NET library	MIT	Free	ASP.NET Core (PdfSharp 6.x supports .NET 6+)	No	Maintained but slow release cadence	Truly free MIT; mature (15+ years); lightweight; go	Older imperative API; weaker docs; no HTML rendering; limited modern typography; smaller community vs QuestPDF	Simple programmatic PDFs; merging/splitting exi	ACCEPTABLE fallback - prefer QuestPDF for new work
DinkToPdf	Backend .NET library (wkhtmltopdf wrapper)	MIT	Free	ASP.NET Core	Yes (older WebKit via wkhtmltopdf)	DEAD - wkhtmltopdf archived 2023; DinkToPdf las	Easy HTML-to-PDF API; works on .NET Core	Underlying wkhtmltopdf is ARCHIVED/UNMAINTAINED; known CVEs; uses old WebKit (no modern CSS); native lib loading issues on IIS; no Windows Server 2022 support	Legacy projects ONLY	AVOID - do not use for new development
iText 7/8 for .NET	Backend .NET library	AGPL v3 / Commercial	Commercial license starts ~\$4000+/yr	ASP.NET Core	Yes (pdfHTML add-on)	Very active (commercial)	Most powerful .NET PDF library; digital signatures	AGPL forces you to open-source the entire EHS codebase if used without commercial license; commercial license is expensive; heavyweight	Regulated industries needing signed PDFs and ac	AVOID under AGPL (would expose EHS source); revisit only if commercial license is bought
IronPDF	Backend .NET library	Commercial (proprietary)	~\$749/dev/yr (Lite); ~\$1499 Plus; ~\$2999 Profes	ASP.NET Core - native fit	Yes (Chromium-based engine)	Active	Polished HTML-to-PDF; simple API; good docume	Paid; per-developer licensing; vendor lock-in	Teams that want fast results with budget and sup	CONSIDER only if QuestPDF + PuppeteerSharp combo is insufficient and budget approved
Spire.PDF (E-iceblue)	Backend .NET library	Commercial / Free Community Edition	Commercial ~\$799+/yr; Free version limited to 10	ASP.NET Core	Yes	Active	Comprehensive API; no native deps; supports for	Free version page-limited (unsuitable for production reports); paid license required for real use	Quick prototypes; small one-off PDFs	NOT RECOMMENDED - free tier too limited; paid alternatives are better
Aspose.PDF for .NET	Backend .NET library	Commercial	~\$2000-\$4000+/dev/yr	ASP.NET Core	Yes	Very active	Enterprise-grade; full PDF spec coverage; multi-lar	Very expensive; overkill for typical EHS reports	Large enterprises with complex PDF workflows ar	NOT RECOMMENDED - cost not justified for EHS scope
Syncfusion Essential PDF	Backend .NET library	Commercial / Free Community License	Free for companies under \$1M revenue and unde	ASP.NET Core	Yes	Active	Free community license fits EHS team size; comp	Heavyweight package; community license has org-size restrictions; vendor lock-in	Teams that already use Syncfusion controls	CONSIDER if Syncfusion already in stack - otherwise pick QuestPDF
@react-pdf/renderer	Frontend (React) library	MIT	Free	React + Vite - native fit	No (React components with limited CSS subset)	Active	React component API (familiar to EHS frontend de	Limited CSS (no full Flexbox/Grid parity); custom font loading complexity; ~400KB bundle; not for printing existing pages	New PDF templates designed as React componer	RECOMMENDED frontend pick if PDF is generated client-side
jsPDF	Frontend (JS) library	MIT	Free	React + Vite	Limited (only via html2canvas - produces image-b	Active	Lightweight; very popular; works fully client-side; A	Pure HTML rendering rasterizes (text not selectable in result); manual layout for quality output; pagination is manual	Simple client-side invoices; programmatic PDFs w	ACCEPTABLE for simple cases - prefer @react-pdf/renderer for richer output
pdfmake	Frontend (JS) library	MIT	Free	React + Vite	No (uses JSON document definition language)	Active	Declarative JSON DSL; great table support; embed	Steep DSL learning curve; verbose definitions; weak HTML interop	Tabular reports; invoices defined as data	ACCEPTABLE - good for table-heavy data exports
html2pdf.js	Frontend (JS) library	MIT	Free	React + Vite	Yes (html2canvas + jsPDF under the hood)	Maintained but slow	Easiest 'click button -> get PDF of this DIV' API; qu	Output is rasterized images (no selectable text; large file size); pagination/page-break quirks; poor multi-page layouts	Quick 'export this view' buttons where fidelity mat	NOT RECOMMENDED for production reports - rasterized output is poor quality